

Information Security Incident Response Procedure

Meridian Industrial Group | IT Security Operations

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1. Purpose

This standard operating procedure establishes the step-by-step process for detecting, responding to, containing, and recovering from information security incidents affecting Meridian Industrial Group systems and data.

2. Incident Classification

Security incidents shall be classified by severity. Severity 1 (Critical): Active data breach, ransomware, or system compromise affecting production. Severity 2 (High): Suspected unauthorized access or malware with potential data exposure. Severity 3 (Medium): Phishing attempts or policy violations without data exposure. Severity 4 (Low): Failed login attempts or minor policy deviations.

3. Response Procedure

Step 1: Detection and Reporting

Any employee who detects or suspects a security incident shall report it immediately to the IT Security Operations Center. The SOC analyst on duty shall create an incident ticket and perform initial triage within 15 minutes.

Step 2: Containment

For Severity 1 and 2 incidents, the SOC shall initiate containment immediately. This may include isolating affected systems, disabling compromised accounts, or blocking malicious IP addresses. Containment actions shall be documented in real time.

Step 3: Investigation

The incident response team shall collect and preserve evidence including system logs, network traffic captures, and forensic disk images. Root cause analysis shall be completed within 72 hours for Severity 1 incidents.

Step 4: Recovery

Systems shall be restored from verified clean backups. All credentials associated with compromised systems shall be reset. Recovery validation testing shall confirm system integrity before returning to production.

Step 5: Post-Incident Review

A post-incident review shall be conducted within 10 business days of incident closure. Lessons learned and recommended improvements shall be documented and distributed to all relevant stakeholders.